

Esther Olajo

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SUMMARY

Full-stack software engineer graduating May 2026 with experience designing, building, and shipping production-grade web and mobile applications across the stack. Strong focus on clean abstractions, maintainable architecture, and user-centric product development. Proven track record of collaborating with stakeholders, validating decisions through data and user research, and contributing to widely adopted open-source software.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, Java, Python, Dart, C++, C, PHP

Frameworks & Libraries: Next.js, React.js, Node.js, Express.js, Flutter, Riverpod, Recharts, Mongoose, Tailwind CSS

Infrastructure: MongoDB Atlas, PostgreSQL, SQLite, Firebase (Auth/Firestore/Storage), Google Cloud Platform, Azure, Docker, GitHub Actions, Vercel

Practices: Full-Stack Development, REST API Design, CI/CD, Agile/Scrum, Applied AI & NLP, User Research & Testing, Responsive & Accessible UI

EXPERIENCE

Dandy — Software Engineering Intern, Product Lines | *June 2026 – August 2026*

- Incoming intern on the Product Lines team, an end-to-end team launching new SKUs across Dandy's digital dental platform — spanning ordering, manufacturing, billing, and support.
- Working across the full stack (React, Node.js) to ship features for a platform serving thousands of dental practices and powering 2M+ restorations.

OPEN SOURCE

Magic Grid — JavaScript, TypeScript, React | *2024 – Present*

- Designed and shipped features for a library with 3.1K+ stars and 246K+ downloads, focusing on clean, extensible API design.
- Led development of use-magic-grid, a React port, building reusable abstractions that enabled seamless integration into React Apps.
- Conducted code reviews, resolved issues, and facilitated team collaboration to deliver features on schedule.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

The Newspaper — Full-Stack News Aggregation Platform

Next.js, TypeScript, React, MongoDB, Recharts, Vercel | 2026

- Built a full-stack platform aggregating real-time news from 7 sources via NewsAPI and NYT API, with search, filtering, and cursor-based pagination across ~400 articles/day.
- Engineered a reusable automated data pipeline using Vercel Cron Jobs for daily ingestion with smart deduplication, upsert writes, and 7-day rolling retention — designed for zero manual maintenance and easy extensibility to new sources.
- Designed interactive data visualizations (bar, line, pie charts) using Recharts for a weather dashboard with geolocation and autocomplete.
- Optimized MongoDB indexing strategies and architected the entire platform to run at \$0/month, balancing performance with infrastructure constraints.

Upstate Underdog Rescue — Nonprofit Client Project

Product Research, Web Development, User Testing | 2026

- Led end-to-end redesign of a nonprofit adoption and donation platform, partnering directly with organizational stakeholders to identify usability, accessibility, and conversion gaps.
- Rebuilt site architecture to improve discovery flows, donation UX, and engagement, prioritizing maintainability so the client could self-manage post-launch.
- Validated design decisions through A/B testing, Likert-scale surveys, quantitative analysis, and AI-driven sentiment analysis; authored a research report translating user data into actionable product recommendations.

Favorite Places — Cross-Platform Mobile App

Flutter, Firebase, Node.js, Google Gemini AI, Cloud Run | 2026

- Architected and shipped a full-stack mobile application using Flutter, Node.js, and Firebase, integrating Google Gemini AI for intelligent tag suggestions and content summarization.
- Implemented serverless backend on Google Cloud Run with Firebase Admin SDK, designing clean service abstractions for authentication, rate limiting, and real-time photo storage.
- Automated CI/CD pipeline via GitHub Actions; achieved \$0/month operational costs through strategic free-tier architecture.

EDUCATION

Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute — Troy, NY | Expected Graduation: May 2026

B.S. Dual Major: Computer Science, Information Technology & Web Sciences | Minor: Cognitive Science

Coursework: Data Structures, Algorithms, Operating Systems, Programming Languages, Principles of Software, Web Systems Dev, HCI & Usability, Logic-Based AI

CERTIFICATIONS & LANGUAGES

Neural Networks & Deep Learning (DeepLearning.AI / Coursera) | Flutter & Dart Complete Guide (Udemy) | **Languages:** English, French